

Lesson 03

Organization Basics



Warm-up

Discussion:

- What departments does your company have?
- Who do you report to in your company? What is their role?
- Do you think a clear company structure is important? Why or why not?



Role-play

Scenario: Company Structure Introduction**Role-Play Dialogue**

John: Welcome to Global Solutions, James! Let me give you a quick overview of our company structure. **Our company is structured into multiple departments.** You'll be joining the Software Development **Department.** **This team is responsible for** developing and optimizing our backend systems.

James: Got it. Who will I be reporting to?

John: Your **direct report** is Sarah Nguyen, the Team Lead for Backend Development.

James: And who does she report to?

John: Sarah **reports to** Daniel Lee, the Engineering Manager. He's your **line manager.**

James: I see. How does communication flow within the company?

John: We follow a clear **company hierarchy** with a **chain of command.** If you have any technical issues, you discuss them with Sarah first.

James: Thanks for explaining.

Role-Play Analysis

Read again and answer the following questions.

1. Which department will James be joining?
2. Who is James's direct report?
3. What is Sarah Nguyen's position in the company?
4. Who is James's line manager?
5. Who should James contact first if he has a technical issue?

Vocabulary: Describing a Company's Structure

When introducing a company's structure, you can use these phrases:

- To explain the general organization of a company:
 - **"Our company is structured into multiple departments."**
- To describe who your direct manager is:
 - **"I report to [position]."**
- To explain a team's role in the company:
 - **"This team is responsible for [task]."**

Example:

- **Our company is structured into multiple departments.** I work in the Software Development Department, and **I report to the** Team Lead. **This team is responsible for** backend development and system optimization.



Practice

1. Match:

Match the terms with their definitions:

Department	A manager directly responsible for employees' work.
Company hierarchy	An employee who reports to a specific manager.
Direct report	The official line of authority in an organization.
Chain of command	The ranking of positions within an organization..
Organizational structure	A division of a company responsible for a specific function.
Line manager	The framework that defines how tasks are divided and coordinated.

2. Discussion: Describing a company's structure

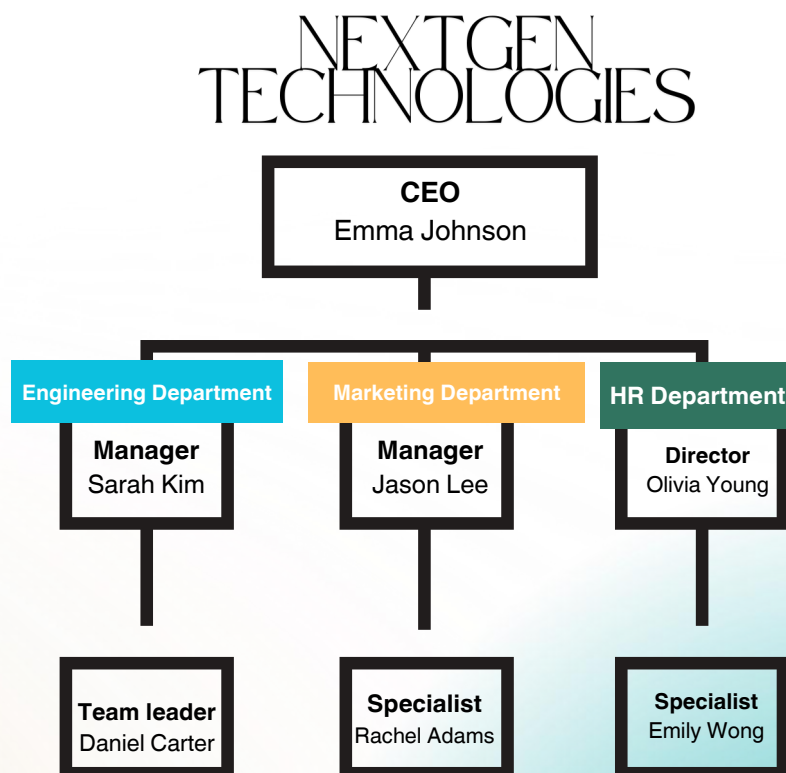
You are an HR employee at NextGen Technologies. Your manager has asked you to explain the company's organizational structure to a new employee based on the company's **organizational chart**.

Remember to use key phrases like:

- "Our company is structured into multiple departments."
- "I report to the [position]."
- "This team is responsible for [task]."

Example:

- Your **direct report** is Daniel Carter, the Team Leader for Engineering Development.





Production

Explain Your Company's Structure

Work in pair and talk with your partners to introduce your company structure. Use the following questions as your guideline:

1. **How is your company structured?** (Use key terms like "departments," "company hierarchy," and "organizational structure.")
2. **Who do you report to, and what is their role?**
3. **How does the chain of command work in your company?** (Explain who makes decisions and how information flows.)
4. **Who is responsible for different tasks in your team or department?**
5. **If someone joins your department, who will be their direct report and line manager?** (Explain relationships within the structure.)



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Definitions	Example
Department	A division of a company responsible for a specific function.	I work in the Marketing Department , which is responsible for managing campaigns and brand awareness.
Company hierarchy	The ranking of positions within an organization.	In our company hierarchy , the CEO is at the top, followed by department heads and then team managers.



Key Vocabulary

Word/Phrase	Definitions	Example
Direct report	An employee who reports to a specific manager.	As a team leader, I have three direct reports who handle content creation and social media strategy.
Chain of command	The official line of authority in an organization.	If there's an issue with a project, we follow the chain of command and report it to our line manager first before escalating it
Organizational structure	The framework that defines how tasks are divided and coordinated.	Our organizational structure is divided into different teams, including sales, engineering, and customer support.
Line manager	A manager directly responsible for employees' work.	My line manager is Jason Lee, the Marketing Manager, who oversees my daily tasks and approves my projects.